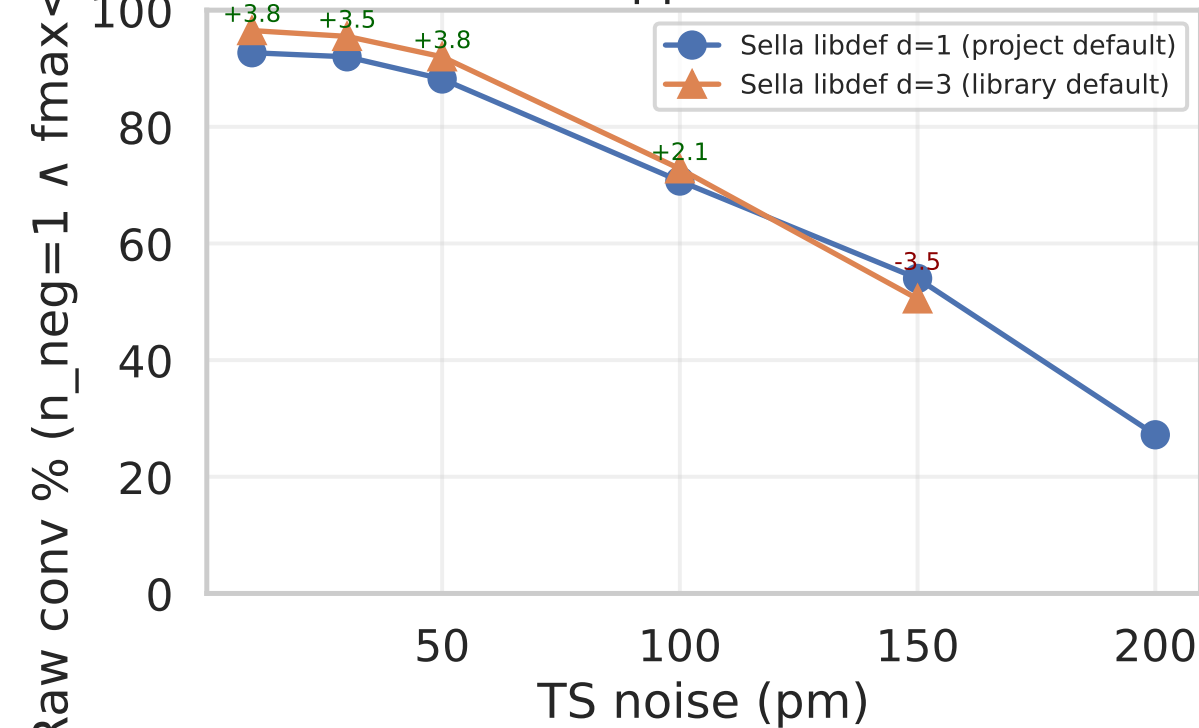


Sella libdef d=1 vs d=3: raw-conv 'wins' for d=3 are wrong-saddle false positives that IRC rejects

Raw conv % (n_neg=1 $\wedge$ fmax < 0.01)

Raw conv: d=3 wins +3-4pp at low noise, loses IRC 150pp: d=1 wins at every noise; gap widens (-0.7 $\rightarrow$ -4.5 pp)



IRC TOPO % (chemistry-validated)

IRC TOPO: d=1 wins at every noise; gap widens (-0.7 $\rightarrow$ -4.5 pp)

